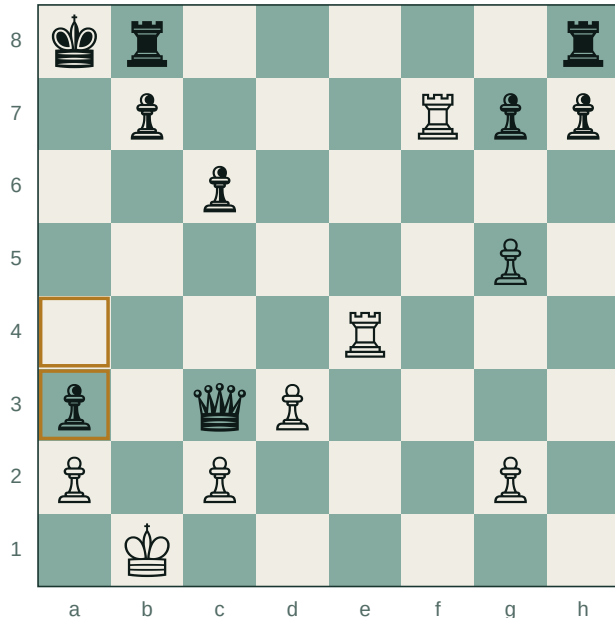


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 33

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 32...a3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Ra4+ Qa5 34. Rxa5#

33.Ra4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **33...Qa5**.

34.Rxa5# Mate: rook on a5 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a5. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on a8. Geometrically undefended: queen on c3. Check for tactical protection.